

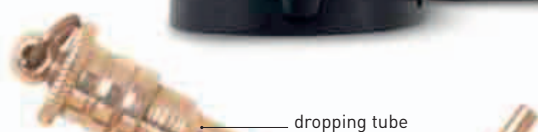


**Carbolic steam spray
1860s**
British surgeon Joseph Lister developed a device to spray carbolic acid in the operating room. The pungent chemical acted as an antiseptic, reducing the chance of wounds becoming infected.

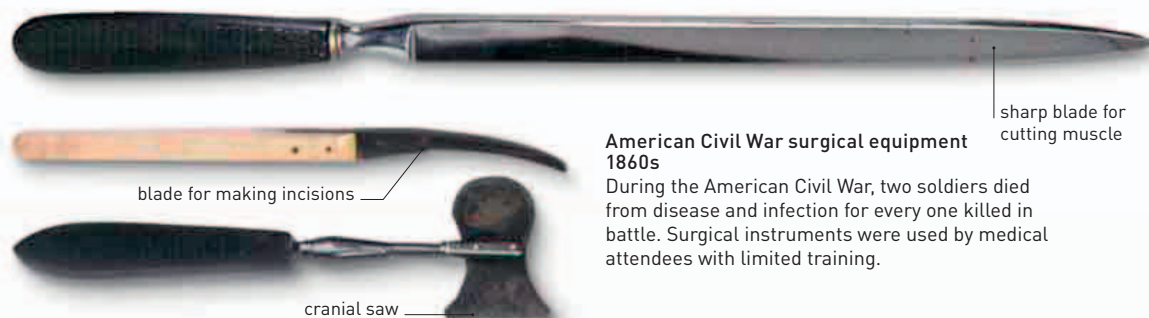
**Barber-Surgeon instruments
Late 1860s**
The scraper and tongue depressor shown here once belonged to a member of the Barber-Surgeon's Company (a guild created by Henry VIII in 1540).



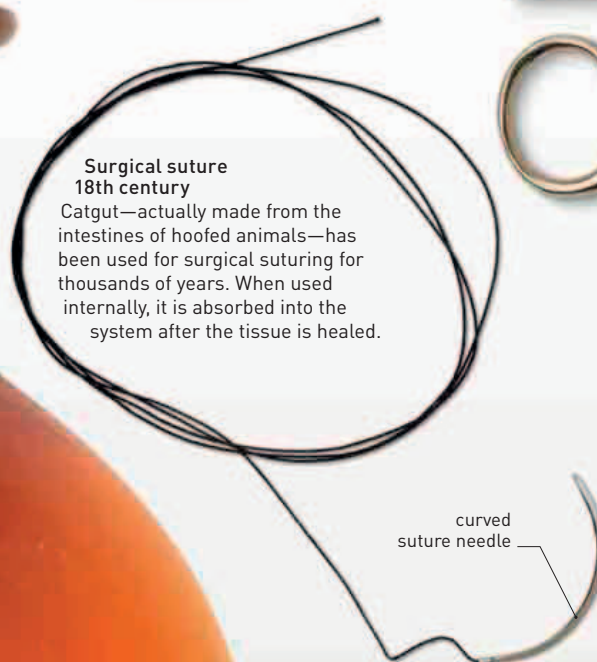
**Surgical sterilizing equipment
1860s**
On battlefields, a hot flame from a portable alcohol burner was used to sterilize surgical instruments supported on a brass stand.



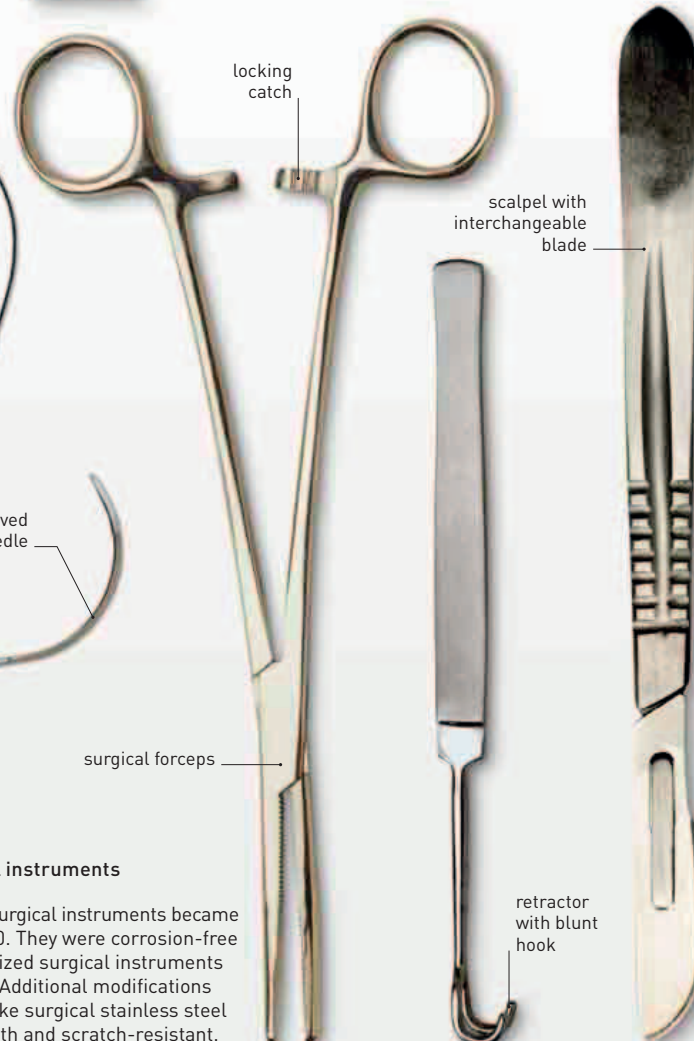
**Esmarch chloroform-ether dropper
c.1890**
English surgeon James Simpson used chloroform as an alternative anesthetic to ether in 1847. Although glass dropping bottles delivered more precise doses, the danger of overdosing persisted until safer anesthetics were developed in the 1950s.



**American Civil War surgical equipment
1860s**
During the American Civil War, two soldiers died from disease and infection for every one killed in battle. Surgical instruments were used by medical attendees with limited training.



**Surgical suture
18th century**
Catgut—actually made from the intestines of hoofed animals—has been used for surgical suturing for thousands of years. When used internally, it is absorbed into the system after the tissue is healed.



**Stainless-steel instruments
20th century**
Stainless steel surgical instruments became available in 1930. They were corrosion-free and easily sterilized surgical instruments could be made. Additional modifications have helped make surgical stainless steel especially smooth and scratch-resistant.

